

Jason's game example is highlighted in blue.

Assignment: Create a Video Game (EXAMPLE ANSWERS)

Develop an original idea for a video game. You do not need to create artwork, write code, or design detailed gameplay systems. Your goal is to communicate a clear and interesting game concept in English.

Imagine that you are going to show this idea to a group of investors. You want to convince the investors to give you money to develop your game!

Answer the following questions in complete sentences.

Part 1: Inspiration

1: What has inspired your game idea?

Name one or two games, movies, TV shows, books, comics, anime, or other media that influenced your idea. What do you like about these influences? How does your game use ideas from them?

For example, Eric Barone was inspired by Harvest Moon when he made his game, Stardew Valley.

Influence 1: The Japanese TV show, はじめてのおつかい (*Hajimete no Otsukai*), called *Old Enough!* in English. In the show, young children have to do some tasks by themselves. I want to use the idea of children doing difficult tasks by themselves. It is very cute and also very emotional.

Influence 2: Wonder Project J (ワンダープロジェクト J: 機械の少年ピーノ) is a Japanese Super Famicom game from 1994. The player has to teach a robot boy named Pino how to live in the world by rewarding him or punishing him. I want to use the idea of teaching a character how to survive in the world. I want to use the praise/scold mechanic, and the player controlling a fairy character.

2. What makes your game different?

Even if your game is inspired by something else, explain one or two unique features or ideas. Your game may be similar to your influences, but it should be a unique, new idea.

What is new or unusual about your game?

In my game the player will have to teach many children, not just Pino. The children are younger (between 4 and 6 years old), like in はじめてのおつかい, and they are human instead of a robot. The children have lots of problems, like getting lost or distracted. They also get upset and cry if they fail.

Why would players want to play your game?

Players want to play my game because the children characters are very cute and charming. The player will want to help the children succeed. I want the game to be an emotional journey, where the player laughs and cries, just like watching the kids in はじめてのおつかい.

Part 2: The Core Idea

3. What is the basic concept of your game? What is the core fantasy? What is the gameplay loop?

Describe your game in 2–4 sentences.

Imagine someone asks: "What is your game about?"

My game is about a fairy (controlled by the player) that helps children complete simple jobs (like getting something from the store). Evil fairies have put the adults under a magic spell, so only small children, who can see the good fairy, are able to complete important jobs around the village. The core fantasy of the game is being a magic helper. The player will love the children characters and want to help them succeed.

The game has two phases in the gameplay loop. In phase 1, the player gives the child instructions. In phase 2, the child tries to follow the instructions, and the player can praise or scold the child. Because the children are so young, they don't always understand the instructions that the player gives them. They also cry easily, fall down and get hurt, go the wrong way, or get distracted by things like cats, candy shops, or other children. The player wins the game by helping all the children in the village and breaking the spell of the bad fairies.

The loop is planning, helping the child do the task, failing or succeeding, and then planning again.

4. What is the setting?

What is the setting of your game? Where does the game take place?

The setting of my game is a small village in the countryside (いなか).

Describe the **atmosphere**. For example, is it a fun, relaxing 'cozy game', or a scary horror game?

The atmosphere is cozy, relaxing, and cute, with an overtone of mystery and magic. The game has a feeling of danger and sadness, but the children never get hurt. There is no violence in the game, but the children and the player fail sometimes.

5. What role does the player play?

How does the player interact with the game? Does the player control a character? Or does the player have a 'bird's eye view' of the game world?

Describe the role the player has, or the character or characters that the player controls. Who are they? What is their role in the world? Why are they important?

In phase 1, the player has to choose from a list of instructions to give the child. If the instructions are too complicated or too simple, the child will get confused, bored, or angry, and won't complete the task in phase 2.

In phase 2, the player controls a fairy that they can move around on the screen. The fairy can help guide the child by praising or scolding them, or by giving rewards.

Part 3: Goals and Player Experience

6. What is the player's main goal?

What is the player trying to accomplish? If the player can win, how do they win the game?

The player wants to break the curse on the village by helping the children complete their tasks. The player helps one child at a time. The goal is to help all of the children around the village to complete their tasks. If all the tasks are completed, the curse that was put on the town by the evil fairies will be broken.

7. What is the mood of the game? How should players feel when they play your game?

Games often have a mood that they create for players. Choose two or three feelings and explain why.

The mood of the game is creative and emotional. The player must try different ways to help the children. Sometimes the player will feel annoyed that the children misbehaved or didn't understand. Other times the player will feel proud that they successfully helped the children.

8. Who is the target audience?

What kind of people would enjoy playing this game? Why would they like it? Explain your choice in 2-4 sentences.

The target audience are casual players, teenagers to adults. The game is challenging, but not too difficult.

9. What themes does the game explore?

Like the mood of a game, the games themes are an overall idea that affects the player's experience. What theme or themes does your game explore?

The themes my game explores are childhood, learning, and fairy magic.

10. Game Mechanics and Unique Features

Do you have a specific game mechanic in mind for your game? If it is not a game mechanic, then what is a unique feature of your game?

In phase one, the player must choose from a list of instructions to explain to the child. The child understands some words and ideas, but doesn't understand others. The children also have preferences. The player must learn what each child understands, likes, and doesn't like, in order to complete the task.

In phase two, the player can move the fairy as the child tries to do their task. The player can give commands to the child, like "stop!", "go", and so on, and the player can praise the child or scold them. Praising the child will make them more likely to do the last behavior that they did. Scolding them will make them less likely to do that behavior. Sometimes the children will not listen or understand. Children have hidden preferences. For example, Child A loves chocolate. If that child walks by the chocolate shop, they will get distracted and go inside to buy chocolate. Child B is afraid of dogs. If child B walks by a dog, they will get scared and start crying.

Part 4: Final Touches

11. Working Title

The working title of my game is *The Little Helper Project*.

12. Genre

This is a puzzle game, with cozy game elements.

13. The Pitch

Summarize your game idea in 50 - 100 words. Briefly explain the main idea, features, mechanics, and so on.

Inspired by the TV show, はじめてのおつかい, and the SNES game, Wonder Project J, The Little Helper Project has players controlling a fairy that has to help young children between the ages of 4 and 7 to complete various tasks around a small village. Evil fairies have put a curse on a small village. The adults are not able to do various tasks around town. The only people who are not cursed are small children (evil fairy magic does not work on anyone younger than 7 years old). Taking on the role of a fairy, the player has to help the children do difficult tasks. For each child that the fairy helps, they have to make a plan in phase 1. In phase 2, the child tries to follow the plan. The player controls a fairy that can help the child, praise or scold them, and reward them, changing the behavior of the child. The player wins when all the children have completed their tasks and the curse is broken.